



PACHISI

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The ancient Indian race game behind Ludo, Sorry!, and Trouble

3

VARIANTS

2-4

PLAYERS

8+

AGE

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Pachisi is an ancient Indian cross-and-circle race game documented from approximately 500 CE, with precursor forms identified in the Painted Grey Ware period (c. 1100–800 BCE). The name derives from the Hindi word *paccīs* (twenty-five), the highest score achievable in the standard cowrie shell throw.

The game is the direct public domain ancestor of several major modern commercial titles:

- ♦ Ludo (1896, UK)
- ♦ Sorry! (1929, United States)
- ♦ Trouble (1965, United States)
- ♦ Aggravation (1962, United States)
- ♦ Parcheesi (US commercial edition)

This library documents only the original public domain Pachisi forms. Ludo, Sorry!, Trouble, and their commercial descendants are not included.

This library includes 3 variants.

VARIANTS

- ♦ [Standard Pachisi](#) — 4 players, six cowrie shells, the foundational form
- ♦ [2-Player Pachisi](#) — 2-player adaptation with teams on the standard board
- ♦ [Seven-Shell Pachisi](#) — 7-cowrie variant with named throw values



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